Section 9. Coordinating Benefits with Medicare and Other Coverage

When you have other health coverage or auto insurance

You must tell us if you or a covered family member has coverage under any other health plan or has automobile insurance that pays healthcare expenses without regard to fault. This is called "double coverage".

When you have double coverage, one plan normally pays its benefits in full as the primary payor and the other plan pays a reduced benefit as the secondary payor. We, like other insurers, determine which coverage is primary according to the National Association of Insurance Commissioners' (NAIC) guidelines. For more information on NAIC rules regarding the coordinating of benefits, visit www.naic.org or geha.com/Multiple-Plans.

When we are the primary payor, we will pay benefits described in this brochure.

When we are the secondary payor, we will determine our allowance. After the primary plan processes the benefit, we will pay what is left of our allowance, minus any cost share you may owe, up to our regular benefit, or up to the member's responsibility as determined by the primary plan, whichever is less. We will not pay more than what we would have paid if we were primary. When applicable, authorization must be given to Us to obtain information about benefits or services available from the other coverage, or to recover overpayments if this Plan previously paid as primary. All terms and conditions of this Plan, as secondary payor, remain in force.

If your primary payor requires preauthorization or requires you use designated facilities or provider for benefits to be approved, it is your responsibility to comply with these requirements. In addition, you must file the claim to your primary payor within the required time period. If you fail to comply with any of these requirements and benefits are denied by the primary payor, we will pay secondary benefits based on an estimate of what the primary carrier would have paid if you followed their requirements.

Please see Section 4, *Your Costs for Covered Services,* for more information about how we pay claims.

This plan always pays secondary to:

- Any medical payment, PIP or No-Fault coverage under any automobile policy available to you.
- Any plan or program which is required by law.

You should review your automobile insurance policy to ensure that uncoordinated medical benefits have been chosen so that the automobile insurance policy is the primary payer.

- **TRICARE and CHAMPVA**

TRICARE is the healthcare program for eligible dependents of military persons, and retirees of the military. TRICARE includes the CHAMPUS program. CHAMPVA provides health coverage to disabled Veterans and their eligible dependents. If TRICARE or CHAMPVA and this Plan cover you, we pay first. See your TRICARE or CHAMPVA Health Benefits Advisor if you have questions about these programs.

Suspended FEHB coverage to enroll in TRICARE or CHAMPVA: If you are an annuitant or former spouse, you can suspend your FEHB coverage to enroll in one of these programs, eliminating your FEHB premium. (OPM does not contribute to any applicable plan premiums.) For information on suspending your FEHB enrollment, contact your retirement or employing office. If you later want to re-enroll in the FEHB Program, generally you may do so only at the next Open Season unless you involuntarily lose coverage under TRICARE or CHAMPVA.